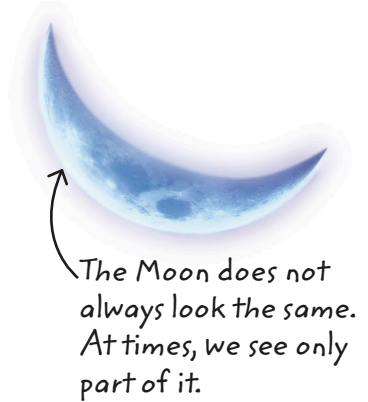


What's in the night sky?

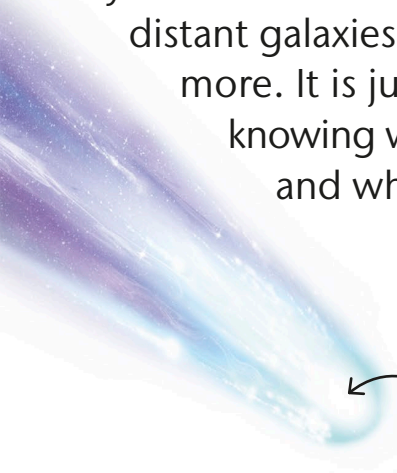
There is more than you might think in the night sky. You may recognize the Moon and stars, but would you know a planet, a galaxy, or a star “nursery” if you saw one? We can see planets, distant galaxies, and much, much more. It is just a matter of knowing what they look like and where to find them.



The Moon does not always look the same. At times, we see only part of it.



Most of the objects in the night sky are stars.



Comets visit the Earth's sky from time to time.

Spaced out

The Moon is the closest object to Earth, so we can see it very clearly. Other objects you see in the night sky are a lot bigger than the Moon, but because they are so much farther away they only look like dots of light to us.



The Sun is our nearest star. It lights up the daytime sky and blots out everything else. The stars, planets, and galaxies are still there—we just can't see them.